JAMES MITCHELL

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Manchester, United Kingdom

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Software Engineer with 10 years of experience building scalable backend systems and leading technical initiatives across fintech and e-commerce sectors. I have a track record of mentoring junior developers, architecting microservices, and reducing infrastructure costs through thoughtful refactoring. I enjoy solving complex performance problems and find satisfaction in writing code that other engineers actually want to maintain.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

Prism Technologies

prism-tech.io

Manchester, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Led the architectural redesign of our payment processing system, reducing transaction latency by 35% and handling 10x traffic growth without infrastructure scaling.

Established coding standards and best practices across 12-person engineering team, implementing peer review processes that reduced production bugs by 40%.

Mentored 5 junior developers through promotion cycles, with 3 progressing to mid-level roles within 18 months.

Designed and implemented event-driven architecture using Apache Kafka, enabling real-time analytics and improving system decoupling across 15 microservices.

Senior Software Engineer

Velocity Solutions Ltd

www.velocitysolutions.co.uk

Manchester, United Kingdom

June 2018 - February 2021

Owned the development of customer-facing API serving 2 million requests daily, maintaining 99.95% uptime and implementing rate limiting and caching strategies.

Built internal tools and dashboards using Python and React that saved the operations team 8 hours per week in manual monitoring.

Drove migration of monolithic application to microservices architecture, reducing deployment times from 45 minutes to 5 minutes.

Collaborated with product and design teams to define technical requirements for new features, resulting in more realistic delivery timelines and fewer scope creep incidents.

Software Engineer

DataFlow Systems

dataflow-systems.net

Leeds, United Kingdom

August 2013 - May 2018

Developed data processing pipelines in Java handling terabytes of financial data daily for institutional clients across Europe and Asia.

Implemented comprehensive unit and integration test suites, increasing test coverage from 42% to 78% and identifying critical edge cases before production.

Participated in on-call rotations, responding to production incidents and implementing post-incident reviews that prevented recurrence.

Collaborated with a distributed team across UK and India, managing timezone differences and ensuring knowledge transfer through documentation.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2013

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend Languages: Java, Python, Go

Web Frameworks: Spring Boot, FastAPI, Django

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch

Message Queues: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, RDS, Lambda, S3), Google Cloud Platform

DevOps and Tools: Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Jenkins, CircleCI

API Design: RESTful APIs, GraphQL, gRPC

Monitoring and Observability: Datadog, Prometheus, ELK Stack

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab